

DELIVERY PLAN

THE CUTDOWN MATRIX

One shoot. Dozens of deliverables. Here's everything to pull from a single music video, broken down by where it's going and what size it needs to be.

4i RECORDS UPDATED SEPT 2026 29-55 DELIVERABLES

The most expensive mistake independent artists make with video is treating the finished music video as the deliverable. It isn't — it's the source. One shoot holds enough material for weeks of posting, and the only thing separating the artists who get that from the artists who don't is whether they planned the cutdowns before the shoot or after.

The math: a three-minute music video is about 180 seconds of finished picture, cut from one to three hours of usable footage. Posting a single 16:9 upload from that uses roughly 3% of what you paid for.

BY PLATFORM

Every platform wants something different out of the same footage — a different shape, a different length, a different energy. The pages that follow give you one platform at a time: what to pull, how many, and the exact size to export it at. Work through them in order and you will have weeks of content from a single shoot.

AT A GLANCE			
YOUTUBE 16:9 · UPLOADS	2-3	YOUTUBE SHORTS 9:16 · CLIPS	7-11
INSTAGRAM 9:16 + 4:5 · POSTS	9-19	TIKTOK 9:16 · CLIPS	10-20
SPOTIFY CANVAS 9:16 · SILENT LOOP	1	FROM ONE SHOOT 10-18 WEEKS OF POSTING	29-55

Every platform wants something different out of the same footage — a different shape, a different length, a different energy. Here's one platform at a time: what to pull, how many, and the exact size to export it at.

YOUTUBE		2-3 UPLOADS
FINAL MUSIC VIDEO The anchor. Lives here permanently and every link you post points back to it.	16:9	1920 × 1080 or 3840 × 2160 · MP4
LONG-FORM BTS VIDEOS ×1-2 Two to ten minutes each. Horizontal outtakes straight from camera, you explaining what you did to make the video, funny moments between takes, bloopers, and shots that didn't make the cut — with your song playing underneath.	16:9	1920 × 1080 2-10 min · MP4
YOUTUBE SHORTS		7-11 CLIPS
LYRIC CLIPS FROM THE FINISHED VIDEO ×3-5 Clips pulled from the final cut with lyrics typed over them.	9:16	1080 × 1920 under 3 min · MP4
CUTDOWNS OF YOUR LONG-FORM BTS ×2-4 The best moments from the BTS videos, reframed vertical.	9:16	1080 × 1920 under 3 min · MP4
SELECTED PORTIONS OF THE FINAL VIDEO ×2-3 Straight excerpts, no text — the strongest visual moments standing alone.	9:16	1080 × 1920 under 3 min · MP4

SAFE AREA · KEEP FACES, LYRICS AND LOGOS INSIDE THE DASHED BOX

UI · 240px

SAFE
960 × 1440

UI · 240px

YOUTUBE SHORTS

Keep main visuals in the central 4:5 area (1080 × 1440). No text in the bottom 10-15%.

INSTAGRAM		9-19 POSTS
TEASER REELS x1-2 Posted as reels, or as trial reels if you want to test them before they hit your followers.	9:16	1080 x 1920 MP4 · 1440 x 2560 for max quality
SOUND DESIGN / A CAPPELLA SHOTS x1-2 One or two shots running with sound design, or an a cappella version of the track underneath.	9:16	1080 x 1920 MP4
LYRIC CLIPS x5-10 Clips from the music video with lyrics cut over them.	9:16	1080 x 1920 MP4
FRAME GRABS & STILLS x1-2 POSTS Edited frames or stills from the music video, captioned with the release announcement.	4:5	1080 x 1350 JPG or PNG · 1440 x 1800 preferred
BTS CAROUSELS x1-3 POSTS Photos from set, funny moments, the parts of the day that didn't look like the final video.	4:5	1080 x 1350 up to 20 per carousel

SAFE AREA · KEEP FACES, LYRICS AND LOGOS INSIDE THE DASHED BOX

UI · 108px

SAFE
960 x 1492

UI · 320px

INSTAGRAM REELS

Top 108px · bottom 320px · sides 60px. Action buttons sit in the right ~180px.

TIKTOK

10-20 CLIPS

BTS, FUNNY MOMENTS, BLOOPERS

×5-10

The rawest material you have. This is the footage that doesn't work anywhere else and works best here.

9:16

1080 × 1920

MP4 · 10 min max on upload

YOU TALKING

×5-10

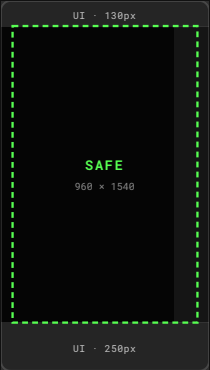
What the song means to you, how you made the video, how you edited it, your favorite shot, what you're most proud of.

9:16

1080 × 1920

MP4

SAFE AREA · KEEP FACES, LYRICS AND LOGOS INSIDE THE DASHED BOX



TIKTOK
Top 130px · bottom 250px · sides 60px. Action buttons sit in the right ~180px.

SPOTIFY CANVAS

1 LOOP

SILENT LOOPING VIDEO

9:16

720 × 1280

Three to eight seconds of selected vertical shots from the music video. Runs behind every single stream of the song.

3–8 sec · MP4 · no audio track

ALL THREE SIDE BY SIDE · THE SAFE BOX IS SMALLEST ON REELS

UI · 108px

SAFE

960 × 1492

UI · 320px

INSTAGRAM REELS

Top 108px · bottom 320px · sides 60px.
Action buttons sit in the right ~180px.

UI · 130px

SAFE

960 × 1540

UI · 250px

TIKTOK

Top 130px · bottom 250px · sides 60px.
Action buttons sit in the right ~180px.

UI · 240px

SAFE

960 × 1440

UI · 240px

YOUTUBE SHORTS

Keep main visuals in the central 4:5 area (1080 × 1440). No text in the bottom 10–15%.

Profile pictures, banners, and cover art sizes live in [the Release Label Visuals Checklist](#).

COUNT YOUR OWN SHOOT

Toggle what you're actually planning to pull and see what one shoot gives you.

DELIVERABLE	COUNT
Final music video	1
Long-form BTS	1–2
Shorts · lyric clips	3–5
Shorts · BTS cutdowns	2–4
Shorts · video excerpts	2–3
IG · teaser reels	1–2
IG · sound design shots	1–2
IG · lyric clips	5–10
IG · frame grab posts	1–2
IG · BTS carousels	1–3
TikTok · BTS & bloopers	5–10
TikTok · you talking	5–10
Spotify Canvas	1
TOTAL	29–55 deliverables · 10–18 weeks at 3 posts/wk

AUTOCALCULATE

Open [4i-cutdown-counter.xlsx](#) in this folder — flip each line YES or NO and the totals update. Or use the live version at [4irecords.com/resources/cutdown-matrix](#).

PLAN THE MATRIX BEFORE THE SHOOT, NOT AFTER

Two decisions on set make all of this possible, and both are free if you make them in advance.

On set **FRAME FOR THE CROP**

Shoot wider than your 16:9 needs, or shoot open-gate, so there's room to reframe vertically without losing the subject. Retrofitting a vertical cut out of a tight 16:9 frame is where cutdowns go to die.

On set **ASSIGN SOMEONE TO BTS**

One person with a phone, all day, shooting both horizontal and vertical. Most of your TikTok and half your Instagram comes from that person, and nothing else on the call sheet produces it.

Hold back four to six clips you never posted. When something unexpectedly catches, you'll want material to follow it with that same week to keep momentum.

THE BEST ARTISTS MAXIMIZE THEIR RESOURCES

Every 4i Productions shoot delivers the final video plus the full cutdown set, and we can cut 20+ clips from your already finished music videos.

[GET A FREE QUOTE →](#)

4i Records — 4 artists. 4 fans. 4 good.

Need help with any part of the process? [4i Productions](#) · [4iproductions.com](#) · [get a free quote](#).

Export specs current September 2026. Re-check before a big release.